

MVP PRODUCT SPECIFICATION

AI Chief of Staff for Restaurants

Designer-ready spec — screens, states, integrations, flows

Prepared for: Abdulhakim & design team · **Version:** MVP v1.0 · **Date:** 30 April 2026

0. How to Use This Document

This is a product spec, not a visual design. The designer owns layout, typography, colour, and motion. This doc tells the designer:

- Who is on each screen, what they're trying to do, and how often they're there.
- Every screen the MVP needs to ship and what each screen contains.
- Every state of every screen (empty, loading, error, offline, success).
- Every integration the product wires into and how setup feels for the operator.
- The product principles to optimise for when there are trade-offs.

How to read the wireframes

ASCII boxes throughout this doc are layout sketches, not visual proposals. They communicate what's on the screen, the rough hierarchy, and the order of elements. The designer is expected to translate these into something beautiful — but the elements, not the look, are non-negotiable.

1. Product Principles

Seven principles to optimise for. When there's a trade-off, fall back to these.

- **1. The owner is on the floor.** Mobile-first. Anything that takes longer than 30 seconds on a phone fails.
- **2. Drafts, not blanks.** Never show an empty text field where AI could have written a starting draft. The owner edits or approves; they almost never type from scratch.
- **3. One-tap approve.** The default for every AI-generated artefact is one tap to approve. Multi-step approvals are a failure of the design.
- **4. Every screen explains itself.** No tutorials, no tooltips you have to find. The first thing on every screen is a one-line description of what the owner is looking at and why.
- **5. Quiet by default.** We send one bundled WhatsApp brief per day. Anything outside that needs to clear a high bar (negative reviews, integration breakage, no-show alerts during service). No badges. No red dots. No streaks.

- **6. Owner data, owner voice.** We never market to their guests on our behalf. Brand voice is theirs. We are infrastructure, not a brand on top of theirs.
- **7. Trust before scale.** For the first 90 days of any account, default everything to “draft, not auto-send.” Only auto-publish a category once it’s passed >95% approval rate for 30 days.

2. Personas

2.1 Maya — Owner / GM (primary persona)

- **Role.** Runs a 3-site independent group. Has a head chef per site and one part-time freelance social media person.
- **Devices.** iPhone 90% of the time. Opens a laptop on a Sunday afternoon for the week ahead.
- **Pains.** Can’t see one customer across all three sites; reviews go un-answered for days; “marketing” means a Mailchimp blast every six weeks.
- **Win condition.** Gets 8–10 hours of admin time back per week; no longer feels behind on reviews; Friday brief tells her exactly what to do.

2.2 Sam — Site manager

- **Role.** Runs one location day-to-day. Reports to Maya.
- **Devices.** iPhone during service; tablet at the host stand; laptop for end-of-day.
- **Needs.** See today’s VIPs, dietary flags, what to say to a 2-star review about their site, who didn’t show up.

2.3 Jess — Host / front-of-house

- **Role.** Greets guests, manages the floor plan during service.
- **Devices.** Tablet at the host stand.
- **Needs.** Pull up a guest as they walk in; see notes; tag “great visit” or “needs recovery” after they leave.

Designer note

Maya gets 80% of the design love. Sam gets a focused tablet/desktop variant of the same screens. Jess gets a single very simple tablet view of the host stand. All three share the same data; they just see different slices.

3. Information Architecture

3.1 Sitemap

```

Auth/
  /signin          (magic link, no password)
  /signup          (invite-only at MVP)

App/
  /today           [home — owner default]
  /guests
    /guests/:id    [unified profile]
  /reviews
    /reviews/:id   [draft + history]
  /conversations
    /conversations/:guestId [thread view]
  /campaigns
    /campaigns/:id [edit + audience preview]
  /sites
    /sites/:id     [details + integrations]
  /settings
    /brand-voice   [voice training]
    /team          [users + roles]
    /billing
    /notifications

Host stand/       (tablet-only, separate IA)
  /tonight         [tonight's bookings]
  /tonight/:guestId [guest in 1 tap]

```

3.2 Navigation pattern

- **Mobile (Maya, Sam):** Bottom tab bar with 5 tabs — Today · Guests · Reviews · Inbox · More. “More” opens Campaigns + Sites + Settings.
- **Desktop / tablet:** Left sidebar with the same 5 primary items expanded; “More” items live below a divider.
- **Host stand (Jess):** Single full-screen view with no nav chrome. Timeline of tonight’s bookings, tap a name to open guest.

Why only 5 tabs

Operators install dozens of apps; the ones that survive on the home screen have ≤ 5 nav items. Anything that grows past 5 is signalling that we’ve started building a CRM instead of a chief of staff.

4. Onboarding Flow (must finish in ≤ 30 minutes)

Onboarding is the only moment the operator will tolerate setup work. Optimise ruthlessly for time-to-first-value: the first useful output (a draft review reply or a guest profile) should appear within 10 minutes of signup.

4.1 Eight-step funnel

1. Magic-link signin from invite email.

2. Group setup: name, time-zone, primary contact phone (this is where the daily brief gets sent).
3. Add your sites: name, address, Google Business Profile selection (autocomplete via GBP API).
4. Connect booking provider: pick one of ResDiary, Access Collins, OpenTable, SevenRooms, Eat App, “Other / not yet”.
5. Connect POS: Square, Lightspeed, Toast, “Other / skip”. (Skippable — POS only adds spend data.)
6. Connect Google Business Profile: OAuth per site.
7. Connect WhatsApp: enter phone number, kick off WhatsApp Business API onboarding (we handle BSP wiring; takes 1–5 days but the rest of the product works without it).
8. Brand voice training: paste/upload past content (or skip and we’ll harvest from Google reviews + GBP automatically).

4.2 Wireframes

Step 2 — Group setup (mobile)

Step 2 of 8

Tell us about your group
Two minutes, then we’re moving.

Group name

The Forge Group

Time zone

Europe/London ▼

Where should I send your daily
brief? (your WhatsApp)

+44 ▼ 7700 900123

Continue

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Step 4 — Connect booking provider

Step 4 of 8

Where do bookings live today?
Pick one — we'll pull guests,
bookings and history.

- ResDiary
OAuth · 2 min

- Access Collins
API key · 5 min

- OpenTable
Email export · daily

- Eat App / SevenRooms /
Other

Continue

← I'll do this later

Step 8 — Brand voice

Step 8 of 8

Train your voice
I'll write in your voice — review
replies, WhatsApp, captions. To
do that, I need a few examples.

Easiest:

Use my Google reviews + GBP
replies (I'll fetch them)

Better:

Paste 3 captions you wrote

3 vibe questions

Pick one: warm · cheeky ·
formal · plain-spoken

Train and finish setup

Time-to-value goal

By the end of step 8 the owner should already see one filled-in example: an actual past Google review of their restaurant, with a draft reply written in the voice we just learned. This is the single most important moment in the entire onboarding. The designer should make this hand-off a delight.

5. Hero Flow — The Daily Morning Brief

This is the product. Every other screen exists to make this brief more accurate. The designer should give the brief disproportionate love.

5.1 How it's delivered

- **Channel:** WhatsApp message to the owner's phone, sent at 08:30 local. SMS fallback if WhatsApp fails. Email digest mirror at 08:35 for the laptop.
- **Reply mechanism:** Owner can reply with "YES" to approve everything, or tap a deep link to open the in-app brief.
- **Length budget:** ≤ 8 lines on the WhatsApp side. Anything longer breaks the "glanceable while making coffee" promise.

5.2 WhatsApp message template

Morning Maya. Today across The Forge Group:

- 47 covers — Hackney 18, King's X 21, Peck 8
- 2 reviews need you (1 four-star, 1 two-star)
- 5 regulars I'd nudge today
- 1 social post drafted for Hackney
- ⚠ Square integration paused — fix needed

Reply YES to send everything I've drafted,
or tap to open: forge.aichief.app/today/0430

5.3 In-app brief screen (mobile)

The mobile app interface for the daily morning brief is shown. It features a header with 'Today' and 'Wed 30 Apr' and a settings gear icon. The main content area displays '47 covers across 3 sites' and 'Approve all I've drafted'. Below this is a button labeled 'Approve everything'. A section titled 'Reviews to send (2)' contains two review cards. The first card is for Sarah at Hackney, showing a 5-star rating, the text 'Loved the lamb, service a bit slow...', a draft status, a thank-you message, and buttons for [Edit], [Approve], and [Skip]. The second card is for Daniel at King's X, showing a 2-star rating, the text 'Felt rushed, wine was...', a negative status with a warning icon, and buttons for [Edit], [Approve], and [Skip].

TodayWed 30 Apr⚙

47 covers across 3 sites
Approve all I've drafted

Approve everything

▼ Reviews to send (2)

★★★★ Sarah · Hackney
Loved the lamb, service
a bit slow...
— Draft —
Hi Sarah — thank you for
the lovely note about
the lamb...
[Edit] [Approve] [Skip]

★★ Daniel · King's X
Felt rushed, wine was...
⚠ Negative — extra care
[Edit] [Approve] [Skip]

▼ Win-backs (5) ▼ Social posts (1) ▼ Anomalies (1)
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5.4 What goes into the brief

Section	Trigger	Default	Owner action
Covers summary	Always	Always shown	None — read-only
Reviews	Any new GBP review since last brief	Show top 5; positive auto-bundle, negative singled out	Approve/edit/skip per item
Win-backs	≥1 regular hit 60-day silence threshold	Cap 5 per day per site	Approve/edit/skip per item
Social posts	Phase 2 only	Cap 1 per site per day	Approve/edit/skip per item
Anomalies	Integration broken, unusual no-show rate, 2+ negative reviews same week	Always escalate, never bundle	Tap to investigate

5.5 Approval mechanics

- **Approve everything** → every default-approved draft is sent / posted; flagged drafts (negative reviews, large discounts) still need explicit per-item approval.
- **Edit a draft** → inline editor; AI shows a “refresh draft” chip if you want a new version.
- **Skip** → marked dismissed; never shown again; logged as “owner declined” for voice training.
- **Snooze** → moves item to tomorrow’s brief. Use sparingly — 7-day snooze cap.

Designer warning

Approval flows are where most AI products lose trust. Every item must show (a) what we’re going to send, (b) where we’re going to send it, (c) the recipient’s name, (d) a clear undo for at least 5 minutes after sending. Lose any of these and the product feels like it’s acting behind the owner’s back.

6. Screen Specifications

Every MVP screen, with persona, device, goal, components, states, interactions, microcopy, and data.

S-01 · Today (home)

Persona	Maya · Sam (read-only summary of their site)
Device priority	Mobile primary; desktop secondary
Goal	Show what needs the owner today and let them clear it in ≤ 90 seconds.

Key components

- Top header: date, group name, settings icon.
- Hero card: today's covers across all sites (totals + per-site breakdown).
- “Approve everything” CTA — disabled if any item requires explicit approval.
- Collapsible section per category: Reviews, Win-backs, Social posts, Anomalies.
- Per-item card: source, snippet, AI draft, [Edit] [Approve] [Skip] [Snooze].
- Bottom safe area: a single line “Last refreshed 3 min ago — pull to refresh.”

States

- **Default.** At least one item across categories.
- **All clear.** Hero changes to “You’re all caught up — go run service.”; soft sun graphic; only covers summary remains.
- **Loading.** Skeleton cards for each category; never spinners.
- **Error (any one source down).** Inline banner: “Couldn’t reach Google reviews. Brief is still good for everything else.” Tap to retry.
- **Offline.** Cached version with a yellow header banner: “Showing your brief from 08:30. Reconnect to refresh.”

Key interactions

- **Tap Approve everything** → Modal: list of every action; “Confirm and send.”
- **Tap a card** → Expands inline; never navigates away.
- **Pull down on hero** → Refresh; fetch new reviews / anomalies.
- **Long-press a card** → Quick actions (Edit, Skip, Snooze).

Microcopy

- **All clear hero:** “You’re all caught up. Go run service.”

- **Approve all confirm:** “Send 7 messages and post 1 reply? You can undo for 5 minutes after.”
- **Negative review badge:** “Soft start”

Data sources

- Reviews: GBP API per site, last 24h.
- Win-back cohort: nightly 03:00 UTC job over Visits table.
- Anomalies: integration health monitor + service-window stats.
- Cover totals: booking provider sync.

S-02 · Guests (list)

Persona	Maya, Sam, Jess
Device priority	Mobile primary; tablet for Jess
Goal	Find a guest in two seconds; see the unified profile across all sites.

Key components

- Search bar at top — name, phone, email; debounced.
- Filters: Site (all/each), Tag, Last visit, At-risk.
- Result row: name, last site visited, lifetime visits, lifetime spend, top tag, traffic-light recency dot.
- Empty state: friendly illustration + “Once we’ve synced your bookings, your guests will live here.”

States

- **Default.** List sorted by last-visit-desc.
- **Empty.** Onboarding sync still running — show progress + ETA.
- **No results for query.** “Nobody by that name yet. Want to add them manually?” [Add guest]
- **Bulk select.** Long-press a row; checkboxes appear; bottom sheet with [Tag] [Add to campaign] [Export].

Key interactions

- **Tap row** → Navigate to S-03 guest detail.
- **Filter At-risk** → Filter to guests with no visit in 60+ days who were previously regulars.
- **Search** → Local index for 1k results; server search beyond.

Microcopy

- **Empty state:** *“Once we’ve synced your bookings, your guests will live here.”*
- **Sync banner:** *“Still importing — 2,140 of 8,300 guests.”*

Data sources

- Unified Guest table (group_id scope).
- Last-visit pulled from Visit table.
- Tags from manual + AI auto-tagging (e.g. “VIP”, “Wine drinker”).

S-03 · Guest detail

Persona	Maya, Sam, Jess
Device priority	Mobile primary
Goal	Tell the operator everything they need to know about this person in 5 seconds.

Key components

- Header: name, photo (if any), at-risk dot, primary site, key tags.
- Stats row: lifetime visits, lifetime spend, avg party, top dish (if POS).
- Allergies / dietary box — pinned, large type, never collapsed.
- Visit timeline: site, date, party, spend, source, notes.
- Conversation history: WhatsApp + email threads in chronological order.
- Actions: [Send WhatsApp], [Add note], [Tag], [Mark VIP].

States

- **Default.** Active profile with ≥ 1 visit.
- **Lead-only.** Booked but never visited — show booking history only, hide spend stats.
- **Anonymous walk-in.** POS-only data, no contact details — show stats, suppress comms actions.
- **Unsubscribed.** Comms actions greyed; banner explains: “Sarah has opted out of WhatsApp.”

Key interactions

- **Tap Send WhatsApp** → Opens conversation S-05 with AI-suggested opener based on context.
- **Tap a tag** → Filter all guests by this tag.
- **Tap a visit** → Visit detail sheet (party, spend breakdown, server, notes).

Microcopy

- **At-risk pill:** *“Last seen 71 days ago — I’d say hi.”*

- **Dietary banner:** *“Severe nut allergy — flag every booking.”*

Data sources

- Guest, Visit, Conversation, Review, Tag tables joined by guest_id.

S-04 · Reviews

Persona	Maya, Sam
Device priority	Mobile primary; desktop for batch review
Goal	Reply to every review in the brand voice within 24 hours.

Key components

- Tabs: Needs reply · Sent · All.
- Filter: Site · Star rating · Source (GBP, TripAdvisor in Phase 2).
- Review card: stars, reviewer name, review text, AI draft, sentiment chip, site, age.
- Bulk action bar: [Approve all positive] [Skip all].
- Per card: [Edit] [Approve] [Skip] [Refresh draft].

States

- **Empty (caught up).** Soft success: “No reviews waiting — last reply 47 minutes ago.”
- **Blocked (GBP not connected).** Banner with one-tap connect button.
- **AI draft failed.** Show a clear placeholder: “I couldn’t draft this one. Try refresh, or write your own.”

Key interactions

- **Tap Approve** → Posts via GBP API; 5-second undo toast.
- **Tap Edit** → Inline editor; tracks edits to improve voice model.
- **Tap Refresh draft** → New draft with same brand voice; can compare.
- **Tap Skip** → Remove from queue; logged for voice training as “rejected.”

Microcopy

- **Negative review banner:** *“Take a beat — this one matters.”*
- **Auto-publish toggle:** *“Auto-send my replies to 4★ and 5★ reviews after 30 days of high approval.”*

Data sources

- GBP API, polled every 30 minutes.
- Review table with status enum: needs_reply | drafted | sent | skipped.

- Edit deltas fed into brand-voice tuning store.

S-05 · Conversations / Inbox (WhatsApp + email)

Persona	Maya, Sam
Device priority	Mobile primary
Goal	Handle inbound guest messages in one place; AI answers FAQs, owner handles the rest.

Key components

- Threads list (left on desktop, top on mobile): guest name, last snippet, unread dot, AI-handled tag if so.
- Thread view: messages in order; AI replies marked with a small badge; suggested next reply at the bottom.
- Composer: text + emoji + template picker (booking confirm, reminder, win-back, custom).
- Side panel: guest mini-profile (visits, allergies, last visit), opt-out toggle.

States

- **AI-handled.** Thread shows green badge: “I answered this one.” Owner can take over any time.
- **Needs you.** Red dot in tabs; pinned to top.
- **Outside 24h window.** Composer shows: “Outside 24h — needs an approved template.”
- **Guest opted out.** Composer disabled; explanation banner.

Key interactions

- **Owner replies** → Sent immediately; AI re-trains nothing on this turn.
- **Tap suggested reply** → Pre-fills composer; one tap to send.
- **Tap template** → Inserts template; merge fields filled with guest context.

Microcopy

- **AI-handled label:** *“I took this one.”*
- **Out-of-window helper:** *“It’s been over 24h — pick a template or wait for them to ping you.”*

Data sources

- Conversation + Message tables.
- WhatsApp BSP webhooks for inbound; outbound via BSP send API.
- Window timer per thread for 24h marketing rules.

S-06 · Campaigns

Persona	Maya
Device priority	Desktop primary; mobile read-only
Goal	Run targeted, opt-in WhatsApp/email pushes without becoming a marketing tool.

Key components

- List of campaigns with status: scheduled, sending, sent, paused.
- Templates: Win-back · Birthday · Seasonal · Custom.
- New campaign builder: audience filter → channel → message → schedule → preview → confirm.
- Audience preview pane: live count + sample 5 recipients.

States

- **Default.** List of campaigns sorted by date.
- **Audience zero.** Builder warns: “Nobody matches — try widening to 90 days.”
- **Sending.** Live progress: 142/300 sent; pause button.
- **Throttle hit.** Banner: “WhatsApp daily volume cap reached — remaining will send tomorrow.”

Key interactions

- **Pick template** → Pre-fills audience and copy; both editable.
- **Tap a recipient in preview** → Opens guest detail in side sheet.
- **Schedule** → Confirm modal repeats audience size + scheduled time.

Microcopy

- **Confirm modal:** “Send to 142 guests on 2 May at 11:00? You’ll be charged 142 marketing messages (~£6).”

Data sources

- Campaign, Audience filter, Send job tables.
- Per-message billing log for cost surfacing.

S-07 · Brand voice settings

Persona	Maya
Device priority	Desktop primary
Goal	Show what voice we've learned and let the owner shape it.

Key components

- Voice card: 3-line summary (e.g. “warm, plain-spoken, dry humour, never exclamation marks”).
- Sample bench: 6 example outputs (review reply, WhatsApp reminder, win-back, IG caption) — owner can rate 👍/👎.
- Source list: where the voice was learned (GBP replies, IG captions, manual paste).
- Toggles: never use emojis · always sign messages with first name · max sentence length · BANNED words list.
- Re-train button.

States

- **Untrained.** Hero CTA: “Train me — 5 minutes.”
- **Trained.** Show summary + samples + last-trained date.
- **Drifting.** If owner has rejected > 30% of last week's drafts: banner suggests re-training.

Key interactions

- **Rate sample** → Update voice tuning weights.
- **Add banned word** → All future drafts blocked from using it.
- **Re-train** → Pull latest content + ratings; show before/after sample.

Microcopy

- **Training success:** “Trained on 184 examples. Here's how I sound now.”

Data sources

- BrandVoice table with config + tuning weights.
- Sample bench cached per voice version.

S-08 · Sites + integrations

Persona	Maya
Device priority	Desktop primary

Goal	Show every site, every connection, and every problem in one view.

Key components

- Site card: name, address, GBP status, booking provider status, POS status, WhatsApp status, last sync time.
- Per-integration health pill: green/amber/red; tap for details.
- Add a site button.
- Per-integration deep view: scopes granted, last successful sync, error log, [Reconnect] [Disconnect].

States

- **Healthy.** All green pills; last sync within 30 minutes.
- **Stale (>2h).** Amber pill; banner suggests reconnect.
- **Broken.** Red pill; integration paused; tap reveals exact error and fix steps.

Key interactions

- **Tap red pill** → Modal with plain-English error + reconnect CTA.
- **Add a site** → Mini-onboarding flow (name, address, GBP).

Microcopy

- **Stale banner:** *"Hackney bookings haven't updated since 6am. Want me to retry?"*
- **Broken banner:** *"Square logged me out. One tap to reconnect (60 seconds)."*

Data sources

- Site, Integration, IntegrationHealth tables.
- Sync log with structured error codes.

S-09 · Team & access

Persona	Maya
Device priority	Desktop primary
Goal	Add managers and hosts without giving everyone everything.

Key components

- Members list: name, email, role (Owner/Manager/Host), site scope.

- Invite by email; role + site picker.
- Per-member: last active, [Edit] [Remove].

States

- **Solo.** Just the owner; encourage adding a manager.
- **Pending invite.** Show resend button + expiry date.

Key interactions

- **Change role** → Confirm modal lists exact permission diff.

Microcopy

- **Empty:** *“Add Sam at Hackney so she can see her site without bothering you.”*

Data sources

- User, Membership tables.
- Role enum: owner | manager | host.

S-10 · Host stand (tablet)

Persona	Jess
Device priority	Tablet only
Goal	Tap a guest as they walk in. See what matters. Tag them after they leave.

Key components

- Big timeline of tonight’s bookings, ordered by time.
- Guest row: time, party size, name (large), VIP / allergy / regular badges.
- Tap → guest sheet with allergies, last 3 visits, “Mark seated”, “Mark left”, post-visit tags.
- Post-visit one-tap tags: Great visit · Recovery needed · New regular?

States

- **Pre-service.** Show full timeline.
- **Mid-service.** Auto-scroll to current hour; dim past.
- **Post-service.** Prompt to tag any unrated guests before close.

Key interactions

- **Mark seated** → Stamps a Visit row.
- **Tag Recovery needed** → Adds to Maya’s tomorrow brief as a personal apology candidate.

Microcopy

- **Allergy banner:** *“SEVERE NUT ALLERGY — please flag in the kitchen.”*

Data sources

- Bookings synced from booking provider every 5 minutes.
- Visit table writes on Mark seated / Mark left.

7. Integration Specifications

Every external system the MVP connects to. For each integration: provider, auth, scopes, sync cadence, owner-facing setup UX, and failure handling.

7.1 Booking providers

Pick ONE provider to support fully at MVP launch (whichever the pilot customer uses). Add the others as fast-followers.

Provider	Auth	Scopes / data	Sync cadence	MVP priority
ResDiary	OAuth 2.0 (Diary API)	Read: bookings, guests, sites, contact details, dietary notes. Write: tag/notes back if customer wants.	5-min poll + webhooks where supported	P0 if customer uses it
Access Collins	API key from Collins admin	Read: bookings, guests, payments, deposits, events.	10-min poll	P0 if customer uses it
OpenTable	Restricted partner API; fallback = nightly CSV via email	Read: bookings, guest contacts (limited per OpenTable T&Cs).	Daily import + manual export trigger	P1
SevenRooms	OAuth (limited via DoorDash partner programme)	Read: bookings, guest profiles, tags.	Hourly	P1 — only if customer is migrating off
Eat App	API key	Read: bookings, guests, dietary, tags.	5-min poll	P1
Other / manual	n/a	CSV upload (booking + guest list).	Manual	P2 fallback

Setup UX

For each provider, build a single setup screen with: a one-line description of what we'll pull, a list of read scopes (no write at MVP), an OAuth button (or API-key field), and a "Test connection" action that pulls the most recent 3 bookings and shows them on the screen as proof.

7.2 POS

Provider	Auth	Data we read	Sync
Square	OAuth 2.0 (Square Connect)	Transactions, items, customer linkage where present, tip totals.	Webhook for new sale + 1-hour sweep
Lightspeed (K-Series)	OAuth	Transactions, items, table linkage.	Webhook + hourly sweep
Toast (US-leaning, optional UK)	OAuth	Transactions, items, table.	Hourly
Skip	—	Spend stats remain blank; we tag guests by visit only.	—

Why POS is optional

POS adds spend data, which is nice-to-have for win-backs and VIP detection. But many UK independents have legacy tills (e.g. ICRTouch) without proper APIs. Make POS skippable; flag where lack of POS limits a feature (e.g. campaign filters by spend).

7.3 Google Business Profile

- **Auth:** Google OAuth 2.0 with the Business Profile Performance + Account Management API scopes.
- **Read:** Reviews, GBP attributes, posts, performance metrics.

- **Write:** Reply to reviews. (We do NOT auto-post until the customer explicitly opts in after 30 days.)
- **Sync:** Reviews polled every 30 minutes per site; webhook unavailable so polling is mandatory.
- **Edge:** Owner must verify each location in GBP before connecting; show a clear pre-flight check.

7.4 WhatsApp Business

- **Stack:** Use a BSP — recommend 360dialog (UK strong, no per-message markup) or Twilio (broad fallback). Do NOT integrate Cloud API direct at MVP.
- **Templates:** Pre-build and submit for approval at onboarding: booking_confirmation, booking_reminder_24h, no_show_check, post_visit_thanks, win_back_60d, birthday, seasonal_push.
- **Inbound:** BSP webhook → our edge function → classifier → router (FAQ bot vs human inbox).
- **Outbound:** Free-form replies inside 24h window; templates outside 24h. Track per-thread window timer.
- **Cost surfacing:** Show the owner per-message cost (~£0.04 UK marketing, free for 24h replies and CTWA-72h conversations) before any send.
- **Compliance:** Capture explicit opt-in at booking widget + post-visit; store consent timestamp + source per channel; honour PECR + Meta policy.

7.5 Instagram (Phase 2)

- **Auth:** Meta Graph API via Instagram Business account linked to a Facebook Page.
- **Scope:** Read past captions for voice training (MVP allowed); post scheduling is Phase 2.
- **MVP behaviour:** Read-only at launch — drafts shown in brief, owner copies/pastes manually until Phase 2 ships true scheduling.

7.6 Email

- **Provider:** Resend or Postmark for transactional. Mailchimp/Klaviyo NOT integrated at MVP — we replace these for many customers.
- **Use cases:** WhatsApp fallback when not opted in; weekly email digest mirror; account/password emails.
- **Sender:** Use customer's own domain (DKIM/SPF setup as part of onboarding step 7.5). Never send from our domain on their behalf.

7.7 AI infrastructure

- **LLM:** Claude (Anthropic) primary; GPT-4 class secondary for fallback. Use Anthropic Files API for brand-voice corpus.
- **Voice tuning:** Lightweight prompt-engineering at MVP (system prompt + RAG over the corpus); fine-tune deferred to Phase 2 once we have ≥ 5 customers.
- **Latency budget:** Brief generation < 6 sec; review draft < 2 sec; FAQ bot < 3 sec.
- **Safety:** Reject drafts containing the BANNED words list; clamp temperature on customer-facing copy; never auto-publish negative responses.

8. Notification Model

Notifications are the easiest way to ruin trust. Default everything to OFF except the daily brief.

Event	Default channel	Cadence	Off by default?
Daily morning brief	WhatsApp + email digest	Daily 08:30 local	On
Negative review (≤ 3 stars)	WhatsApp	Within 5 min of detection	On
Integration broken	WhatsApp + email	Within 2 min	On
Inbound message bot can't handle	WhatsApp	Within 1 min	On
Campaign sent	Email digest only	On completion	On
Daily covers above/below threshold	Email digest only	Daily	Off
At-risk regular detected	Bundled into next brief	Daily	On
Marketing-y nudges ("you haven't logged in!")	—	—	Forbidden

Notification policy

If we wouldn't wake the owner at 3am for it, it goes in the next brief. Negative reviews and broken integrations are the only events that get to interrupt service. No streak nudges, no "you haven't logged in!", no engagement-bait notifications — ever.

9. Universal States

These states apply to every screen unless explicitly overridden in §6.

9.1 Loading

- Skeleton structure that mirrors final layout. Never spinners.

- Show real data as it arrives — don't wait for the slowest piece.
- If anything is taking >3 seconds: subtle “still fetching reviews from Google...” toast at the bottom.

9.2 Empty

- Always paired with a one-line explanation and one CTA.
- Use empty states to teach the product. Don't waste them on cute illustrations alone.

9.3 Error

- Plain English. No “Error code 502” unless the user asks for details.
- Always offer a next action: retry, reconnect, or “tell us” via support.
- Persist a record so we can fix it without the owner reporting it.

9.4 Offline

- Read-only access to the cached morning brief and last-known guest list.
- Yellow header banner: “You're offline — last update at 08:30. We'll reconnect.”
- Composer disabled with explanation.

9.5 Success

- Toast for fast actions (≤ 2 sec); inline confirmation for slower ones.
- Always say what was sent, to whom, and offer Undo for 5 minutes (where reversible).

10. Microcopy & Tone

- **Voice:** Calm, plain-spoken, slightly British understated. Like a senior manager who has done this for 20 years.
- **Avoid:** AI buzzwords (“GPT”, “LLM”, “powered by”), exclamation marks, emojis in product chrome (emojis from owners are fine), jargon.
- **Always:** Refer to the AI in first person (“I drafted this”, “I'd say hi”). It's a chief of staff, not a tool.
- **Numbers:** Spell rules: 47 covers, £6, 3 sites. Never “three sites”; never “47 (forty-seven)”.
- **Currency:** Always GBP, always £ symbol, no decimals for marketing-cost surfacing under £1 (use “~£1”).
- **Time:** 24h clock for service-side screens; “3 min ago” for activity feeds.

Sample copy bench

Context	Good	Bad
Approve all confirm	Send 7 messages and post 1 reply? You can undo for 5 minutes after.	Are you sure?
Empty inbox	All clear. Nothing waiting on you.	No new messages 🎉
Error: GBP down	Couldn't reach Google reviews. Brief is still good for everything else.	Network error 502
Negative review badge	Soft start	URGENT NEGATIVE
Onboarding finish	I've drafted my first reply for you. Take a look.	Setup complete!

11. Visual System Suggestions

The designer owns the visual system. The constraints below are product-driven, not aesthetic.

- **Density:** Comfortable, not dense. Operators are reading on a phone with butter on their hands.
- **Touch targets:** Minimum 44×44 pt on mobile. No exceptions for the host stand.
- **Type:** One sans-serif system. 16pt minimum for body. 14pt for metadata. 24+ for hero numbers (covers count, etc.).
- **Colour:** Palette has to work in a busy kitchen pass-through. Avoid red except for blocking errors. Use one warm accent and one cool primary.
- **Iconography:** Outline icons throughout. Filled only for selected/active states.
- **Motion:** Subtle. The morning brief should feel like a newspaper landing on the doormat, not a slot machine.
- **Dark mode:** Required from MVP. Hosts run iPads at night.

Brand-voice for the product itself (suggestion)

Working name: “Forge.” Tagline: “Your back office, while you run the floor.” Designer can propose alternatives.

12. Accessibility minimums

- WCAG 2.2 AA throughout.
- Every interactive element labelled for VoiceOver/TalkBack.
- Dynamic type support up to 200% on iOS/Android.
- All colour-conveyed information has a non-colour fallback (e.g. dot + label).
- Time-sensitive flows (approve all) keep an undo window of ≥5 minutes.

13. Telemetry

What we measure — both for product and for the customer success conversation.

Metric	Why it matters	Surface
Time-to-first-approval	Onboarding success.	Internal + customer dashboard
% of brief items approved (by category)	Voice quality + draft quality.	Internal

Metric	Why it matters	Surface
Owner-edit deltas on drafts	Voice tuning fuel.	Internal voice store
Hours saved/week (estimated)	Pricing justification.	Customer dashboard
Win-back conversion (60-day cohort that books within 30 days of nudge)	Marketing ROI.	Customer dashboard
Review reply latency	SLA story.	Customer dashboard
Integration health uptime	Trust.	Customer dashboard + alerts

14. Explicitly Out of Scope (MVP v1)

- Replacing the booking engine — integrate, never replace.
- Voice/phone agent — partner with Loman or Palona until Phase 2.
- Loyalty programmes, gift cards, ticketing, paid ads.
- Inventory, payroll, staff scheduling.
- Multi-language UI — English only at launch (the customer-facing messages can be multi-lingual via brand-voice config).
- Public booking widget — at MVP we feed off existing booking provider widgets.

15. Screen Inventory (designer checklist)

Code	Screen	Device	Persona	States
S-01	Today (home)	Mobile · Desktop	Maya, Sam	5
S-02	Guests list	Mobile · Tablet	All	4
S-03	Guest detail	Mobile	All	4
S-04	Reviews	Mobile · Desktop	Maya, Sam	3
S-05	Conversations / Inbox	Mobile	Maya, Sam	4
S-06	Campaigns	Desktop	Maya	4
S-07	Brand voice	Desktop	Maya	3

Code	Screen	Device	Persona	States
S-08	Sites + integrations	Desktop	Maya	3
S-09	Team & access	Desktop	Maya	2
S-10	Host stand	Tablet	Jess	3
O-01	Auth (signin)	All	All	Standard
O-02	Onboarding flow (8 steps)	Mobile · Desktop	Maya	Per step
N-01	Daily brief — WhatsApp message	n/a (chat surface)	Maya	1
E-01	Empty / first-run states	All	All	Per screen
E-02	Error / offline states	All	All	Per screen

16. Build sequence (paired with the designer)

9. Week 1: O-01 auth + S-08 sites & integrations skeleton + S-09 team. Designer ships hi-fi mocks for the onboarding flow.
10. Week 2: O-02 onboarding (steps 1–4: group, sites, booking, POS). Engineering wires ResDiary or Collins.
11. Week 3: O-02 steps 5–8 (GBP, WhatsApp, voice). S-07 brand voice MVP. Designer ships S-01 + N-01 hi-fi.
12. Week 4: S-04 reviews shipping. Backend brief generator running. First end-to-end review reply through the system.
13. Week 5–6: S-01 today + N-01 WhatsApp brief live. S-02 + S-03 guests list/detail.
14. Week 7: S-05 conversations / WhatsApp inbox. Inbound bot v1 (FAQ only).
15. Week 8: S-06 campaigns (win-back + birthday templates only).
16. Week 9: S-10 host stand. Polish pass on every screen with designer.
17. Week 10: pilot launch with the customer at all sites.

17. Open decisions for the team

- **Booking provider for v1:** Confirm whichever the pilot customer uses. This decision drives 3 weeks of work.

- **Brand naming:** “Forge” is a placeholder. The designer can propose alternatives in week 1.
- **BSP:** 360dialog vs Twilio. Lean 360dialog for UK pricing; Twilio if we want fastest setup.
- **Auto-publish thresholds:** Default to “drafts only” for first 90 days; revisit after pilot data.
- **Multi-tenant pricing:** Fixed per-site price vs blended group price. Recommend per-site.

Appendix — References

- [WhatsApp Business pricing UK 2026 — SleekFlow](#)
- [WhatsApp Business compliance 2026](#)
- [ResDiary integration platform](#)
- [Access Collins \(UK\)](#)
- [Google Business Profile API](#)
- [Square Connect API](#)
- [Lightspeed K-Series API](#)
- [Twilio WhatsApp pricing](#)